

So, I thought I would crowdsource some catharsis for you as part of this step, because it's much easier to open yourself up to facing and forgiving your financial mistakes when you know others are right there with you. Here are a few that come up repeatedly in my conversations with people – on social media, in workshops, and in real life:

- Lending money to family, friends or ex-partners.
- Borrowing money from friends and family and not being able to afford to pay it back.
- Borrowing from savings to cover monthly outgoings and never putting it back.
- Getting a credit card as soon as they turned eighteen, not really knowing how to manage them.
- Defaulting on bills that went to the wrong address.
- Not paying fines on time and allowing fees to spiral.
- Not cancelling credit cards after they're paid off.
- Blowing a large inheritance.
- Spending to try to keep up with others.
- Relying on credit cards and not being real about what they could afford.
- Taking a consolidation loan to pay off credit cards, then maxing them out again.
- Never checking their bank account.
- Not thinking about the future.
- Not starting to save sooner.

These are all mistakes that completely normal, functioning adults make all the time, and this is just a small fraction of a